Haligric Research Integration Series

BODY FENG SHUI

A COMPLETE DEEP DIVE

Feng Shui's Bagua, Five Elements, and Commanding Position Applied to the Human Body

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The house holds still. The body never does.

Feng shui was born to read wind and water moving through a dwelling, to find where qi pools and where it drains, and to place the door, the bed, the desk so life could enter unobstructed. This book asks a newer question, one no ancient master posed but many modern teachers now do: what happens when the dwelling is not a house at all, but the body that walks around inside one?

Body feng shui is not a lost scripture. It is a living synthesis — feng shui's own bagua, Five Elements, and commanding position turned inward, laid over shoulders and hips and the private weather of an aching lower back, and read against the older, deeper grammar of Chinese medicine's meridians and organ networks, which share the same five elements and give the metaphor its real physiological ground.

What follows is a full working map: the nine life-areas of the bagua traced across the body, the elements traced through organ, emotion, and posture, the commanding stance rebuilt as something you can carry through a doorway or a difficult meeting, and a full kit of self-massage, breath, and clearing rituals for the places where a life goes still.

Treat it honestly, as its practitioners increasingly ask readers to: as an applied extension, not an unbroken lineage. Its truth is tested in the shoulders, not in a footnote.

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What Is Body Feng Shui?

Body feng shui is a modern applied extension of classical feng shui — not a separate ancient tradition with its own founder, canon, or unbroken lineage. It takes the working assumptions of feng shui, that qi (vital energy) flows through an environment, that flow can pool, stagnate, or be swept clean by wind and water, that placement and orientation change how energy moves, and that a well-arranged space supports a well-lived life, and it applies those same assumptions to the body itself, treating the body as the smallest and most intimate environment a person will ever furnish.

This is an honest distinction worth holding onto throughout this deep dive. Classical feng shui (fengshui, literally 'wind-water') developed over roughly three thousand years in China as a system for siting graves, homes, and cities in relation to landscape, compass direction, and qi flow, formalized through Form School (landscape-based) and Compass School (directional, using the luopan compass and bagua) branches. Traditional Chinese Medicine (TCM), including acupuncture, qigong, and meridian theory, developed alongside it, sharing the same root cosmology of qi, yin-yang, and the Five Elements (Wu Xing), but organized around the body's internal organ networks rather than a dwelling's rooms.

Body feng shui, as it is written about today by wellness bloggers, feng shui consultants, and some qigong teachers, deliberately borrows the vocabulary and diagrams of the first (bagua maps, commanding position, clutter clearing) and layers them onto the body using the genuinely shared cosmology of the second (Five Elements, organ correspondence, qi stagnation). Where the metaphor is loose, this book says so. Where the underlying physiology is real and shared, drawn from actual TCM Five Element theory, this book treats it with the depth it deserves.

Origins and Key Voices

No single founder or foundational text originated body feng shui as its own discipline. It emerged gradually, over the past three to four decades, at the intersection of three older streams: Western popularizations of feng shui for the home (which surged in the 1990s and 2000s through authors like Lillian Too, Karen Kingston, and the Black Sect Tantric Buddhist adaptations taught by Professor Thomas Lin Yun), TCM-based wellness writing that already used the Five Elements to explain organs and emotions, and the broader 'energy medicine' and mind-body wellness culture of the same decades, which was hungry for spatial metaphors it could apply to the self.

Karen Kingston's clutter-clearing feng shui work in the 1990s (Clear Your Clutter with Feng Shui) is frequently cited as a bridge text: she explicitly argued that clutter in a home mirrors and reinforces clutter in a person's body, mind, and emotional life, which primed readers to read their own bodies in feng shui terms even though her core subject remained the house.

Later book-length treatments made the body itself the direct subject. Nancy SantoPietro's Feng Shui and Health: The Anatomy of a Home applied bagua-area thinking to physical wellbeing room by room. Daniel Santos's Feng Shui for the Body: Balancing Body and Mind for a Healthier Life is one of the more direct efforts to build a body-bagua system, mapping the nine bagua areas onto body regions and organs and pairing each with specific health guidance. Contemporary wellness writers and feng shui consultants (bloggers such as those at The Qi Flow, Red Lotus Letter, and various qigong-adjacent practitioners) continue to publish and refine body-bagua and body-element frameworks online, which is where most people encounter this material today, rather than in any single canonical book.

None of these authors claim ancient scriptural authority for the body-bagua mapping specifically; most are explicit that they are applying feng shui's structure to a new domain. The deeper legitimacy comes not from their innovation but from the genuinely ancient and shared Wu Xing (Five Element) theory underneath it, which both feng shui and TCM inherited from the same classical Chinese cosmological sources, including the Yijing (I Ching) and Han-dynasty correlative cosmology.

The Body as an Energetic Environment

The central move of body feng shui is a single analogy, taken seriously: if a house is a container through which qi should flow freely, entering through a commanding front door, circulating through open, well-lit rooms, and never pooling in cluttered corners or stagnant back hallways, then the body is a container through which qi should flow the same way, entering through breath and the crown, circulating through open joints and a lengthened spine, and never pooling in clenched shoulders, a collapsed chest, or a locked jaw.

In classical feng shui, qi enters a building through its main door (the 'mouth of qi'), travels along clear pathways, and either nourishes the occupants or turns stagnant and harmful depending on the arrangement of furniture, light, clutter, and structural features like beams, sharp corners, and blocked windows. Body feng shui reads breath as the body's main door, the spine and major joints as its structural corridors, muscular tension and poor posture as its clutter and sharp corners, and organs as its rooms, each with a function, a mood, and a capacity to become 'stuffy' or 'stale' when neglected.

This is where the metaphor earns real substance rather than staying purely poetic: TCM already describes qi moving through the body along meridians, pooling at acupoints, and becoming stagnant when blocked by cold, tension, poor posture, shallow breathing, or unexpressed emotion, precisely the same vocabulary of 'flow' and 'blockage' that feng shui uses for rooms. Body feng shui's writers are, in effect, translating TCM's internal map back into feng shui's spatial language, because both languages were built from the same root ideas of yin-yang and Wu Xing.

The Bagua Map on the Body

In classical feng shui, the bagua is a nine-area grid (sometimes eight areas plus a center) overlaid on a home's floor plan, each area associated with a life domain: Wealth (Xun), Fame/Reputation (Li), Relationships/Love (Kun), Creativity/Children (Dui), Helpful People/Travel (Qian), Career (Kan), Knowledge/Self-Cultivation (Gen), Family/Health (Zhen), and Center/Health-Unity (Tai Chi).

Body feng shui writers overlay this same nine-area grid onto the body, usually from head to feet or front to back, producing a body bagua. Common mappings (these vary somewhat by author, since this is an evolving synthesis, not a fixed canon):

Head and crown correspond to Helpful People/Travel and to spiritual connection — the 'roof' of the personal structure, where outside support and guidance are received.

Throat and upper chest correspond to Fame/Reputation and self-expression — the body's 'south-facing façade,' where the true voice is either broadcast clearly or muffled by a collapsed chest and clenched throat.

Shoulders and upper back correspond to Career and the load-bearing structure of a life — chronically raised or hunched shoulders read, in this framework, the way a blocked front entrance would read in a house: effort is being spent just getting in the door.

Chest and heart center correspond to Relationships/Love and the Center/Health area simultaneously — the physical and metaphorical middle of the structure, where Fire-element warmth toward others is generated or withheld.

Solar plexus and digestive core correspond to Wealth and to Earth-element nourishment — the 'kitchen and pantry' of the body, where resources (food, but also self-worth) are processed and stored or hoarded.

Lower back and kidneys correspond to Family and to Water-element reserves — the body's foundation and 'ancestral hall,' where inherited patterns, fear, and long-term vitality are held.

Hips and pelvis correspond to Creativity/Children — the generative, hinge-bearing region, associated with how freely a person moves forward into new projects and relationships.

Legs and feet correspond to Knowledge/Self-Cultivation and to the body's grounding connection to earth — its literal foundation and the seat of steady, self-directed growth.

The center of the torso, roughly the navel and solar plexus taken together, corresponds to the Health/Unity center, the bagua's ninth area, treated in body feng shui as the hub that all the others must stay connected to for the whole structure to feel whole.

The Five Elements: Feng Shui and TCM in the Same Body

The Five Elements (Wu Xing) are the deepest real connective tissue between feng shui and TCM, because both systems inherited the same Wu Xing cosmology from classical Chinese thought rather than developing separate versions independently. Wood, Fire, Earth, Metal, and Water are not literal substances in either system; they are five phases or qualities of qi, each with a season, direction, color, emotion, organ pair, and generative/destructive relationship to the other four (the generating cycle: Wood feeds Fire, Fire creates Earth [ash], Earth bears Metal [ore], Metal enriches Water [minerals], Water nourishes Wood; and a controlling cycle running the same elements in a different order).

In TCM, each element governs a paired yin/yang organ system, a sense organ, a tissue, an emotion, and a season: Wood governs the Liver and Gallbladder, the eyes, tendons, the emotion of anger (and its healthy form, assertive vision and planning), and spring. Fire governs the Heart and Small Intestine, the tongue, blood vessels, the emotion of joy (and its excess, agitation or manic overexcitement), and summer. Earth governs the Spleen and Stomach, the mouth, muscles, the emotion of worry or overthinking, and late summer. Metal governs the Lungs and Large Intestine, the nose, skin, the emotion of grief (and its healthy form, discernment and letting go), and autumn. Water governs the Kidneys and Bladder, the ears, bones, the emotion of fear, and winter.

Feng shui applies the identical five elements to space and object qualities rather than organs: Wood corresponds to columns, plants, and rectangular shapes, and the color green; Fire corresponds to triangular shapes, candles, and the color red; Earth corresponds to square shapes, ceramics, and yellow/brown tones; Metal corresponds to round shapes, metal objects, and white/grey/metallic tones; Water corresponds to irregular, flowing shapes, mirrors and fountains, and black/deep blue tones.

Body feng shui's real contribution is simply to hold both element sets over the same body at once, so that a person can read the Liver (TCM) and the color green plus Wood-shaped posture cues (feng shui) as a single integrated Wood-element diagnostic: a Wood-depleted body might show a tense jaw, shallow irritability, a slouched, compressed torso (poor 'column' posture), and a wardrobe or bedroom oddly empty of green and growing things, and the recommended remedy draws on both traditions at once — gentle stretching of the sides of the torso where the Liver/Gallbladder meridians run, time outdoors among actual wood and plants, and reintroducing green tones and tall, upright shapes into daily surroundings and dress.

The Commanding Position: How You Hold Your Body

In classical feng shui, the commanding position describes where to place a bed, desk, or stove: diagonally across from the entry door, against a solid wall for support, with a clear view of the door but not directly in its line, so the occupant can see what is coming without being destabilized by it and is backed by protection rather than exposed. It is fundamentally a principle about being supported from behind while remaining aware and unblocked in front.

Body feng shui translates this directly into posture and stance. The 'solid wall at the back' becomes an engaged, lengthened spine and grounded pelvis; the 'clear view of the door' becomes an open chest and unclenched throat that can see and speak to what is approaching in a conversation or a room; being 'not directly in the line of the door' becomes standing at a slight, stable angle rather than squared up and braced, which in both feng shui and body-language research reads as defensive rather than commanding.

A practical commanding-position check, drawn from how feng shui consultants describe the furniture principle and adapted to the body: feet shoulder-width, weight evenly on both, knees soft rather than locked (a locked knee is read the way a jammed door is read — rigid, not resilient); spine long from tailbone to crown, as though a wall behind the shoulder blades were offering support without letting the shoulders round forward onto it; chest open enough that a full breath can move through it, but not thrown back into a militaristic brace, which body feng shui treats as its own kind of blockage (armor, not openness); chin level, throat soft, gaze direct but not fixed, the equivalent of seeing the door without staring at it.

Practitioners suggest checking this stance deliberately before a demanding conversation, a negotiation, or simply before walking into a crowded room, the same way a feng shui consultant would check a desk's placement before a big meeting: not for luck, but because the stance itself changes how present and unshaken a person feels, and, by the logic of the system, how freely qi can move through the torso rather than being braced and clenched against contact.

Reading Qi Blockage in the Body

TCM's concept of qi stagnation gives body feng shui its clinical backbone: qi is understood to flow through channels (meridians) that can become blocked by cold, poor posture, shallow breathing, unexpressed emotion, or sheer stillness, and a blockage anywhere along a channel causes discomfort or dysfunction at that point and often downstream from it. Common signs practitioners describe for stagnant qi include localized pain or tightness that moves or changes with mood, bloating, a sensation of pressure or fullness (frequently in the chest or abdomen), irritability, sighing, and a general sense of being 'stuck.'

Body feng shui reads these same signs spatially, the way a feng shui consultant would read a cluttered hallway or a beam pressing down over a bed: chronically tight shoulders and upper back are read as a blocked 'front entrance,' where too much qi is being spent just getting in the door of a task or a room; a tight jaw and throat are read as a jammed 'Fame/Reputation' area, where self-expression cannot get out; a gripped lower back is read as a blocked 'Family/Foundation' area, where old inherited weight has nowhere to go; a clenched solar plexus is read as clutter in the 'Wealth' area, resources (digestive, financial, emotional) taken in but not properly processed or released.

The remedy logic in both systems is the same: find where qi has pooled or stagnated, then open a clear, unobstructed path for it to move again, using breath, movement, warmth, or a change in the immediate environment (posture, clothing, room), rather than forcing the tension out directly.

Ceremonies and Step-by-Step Self-Care Practices

The following practices are drawn from real qigong self-massage sequences, TCM acupressure-point protocols, and feng shui morning-ritual guidance, adapted here into a body-feng-shui sequence organized by the bagua areas above. Each is written as a literal step-by-step practice, not a metaphor.

PRACTICE ONE — The Nine-Area Body Scan (5 to 10 minutes, best done on waking). Stand or sit with the spine long. Take three slow breaths, four counts in through the nose, hold for two counts, six counts out through the mouth. Beginning at the crown (Helpful People/Travel area) and moving down to the feet (Knowledge/Self-Cultivation area), pause at each of the nine body-bagua zones described above for one full breath cycle, silently naming what you notice there: warmth, tightness, numbness, ease. This is a diagnostic ceremony, not a fix; its purpose is to locate where today's qi has pooled before treating it.

PRACTICE TWO — Opening the Front Door (throat, chest, shoulders; 3 to 5 minutes). Interlace the fingers and turn the palms outward, extending the arms forward at shoulder height, then draw them out to the sides and around behind you, opening the chest fully as you inhale for a count of four; hold the open-chest position for a count of two; release the arms forward and down as you exhale for a count of six, rounding the upper back gently. Repeat six times. This is adapted from qigong chest-opening sets used to relieve upper-back and chest qi stagnation, and it directly targets the 'Fame/Reputation' and 'Career' body-bagua zones.

PRACTICE THREE — Kidney and Lower Back Warming (Family/Foundation area; 2 to 3 minutes). Rub the palms together briskly for ten to fifteen seconds until warm. Place them directly over the kidneys, on the lower back just above the waistline on either side of the spine. Rub in small firm circles, twenty to thirty times, then hold the warm palms still against the skin for three breath cycles. This self-massage is a standard qigong and TCM home practice for supporting Kidney-Water energy and easing lower-back qi stagnation associated with fear and depleted reserves.

PRACTICE FOUR — Wood-Element Side Stretch (Liver/Gallbladder meridian, ribs and sides; 2 minutes per side). Stand with feet hip-width. Inhale and raise one arm overhead, exhaling as you lean gently to the opposite side, feeling the stretch along the ribs and the outer leg, where the Gallbladder meridian runs. Hold for four full breaths, feeling for release rather than forcing depth. Switch sides. This targets stored irritability and a compressed torso, both associated in Five Element theory with a congested Wood element.

PRACTICE FIVE — Acupressure for the Solar Plexus/Wealth Area. Using two fingers, locate the point roughly three finger-widths below the base of the sternum (near CV12/Zhongwan in TCM mapping, used traditionally to support digestion). Press with moderate, steady pressure for thirty seconds, release for ten, and repeat three times, breathing slowly throughout. This is drawn directly from standard acupressure-point protocols for digestive stagnation and is reframed here as clearing the body-bagua Wealth area.

PRACTICE SIX — Evening Closing the Door (grounding, before sleep; 3 minutes). Sit or lie down. Place both palms flat on the lower belly, just below the navel (the body-bagua Center/Health area). Breathe slowly, four counts in, six counts out, for twelve full breaths, feeling the belly rise and fall under the palms. This closes the day's qi circulation the way a feng shui household ritual might close and lock the front door at night, signaling the body-environment that it is safe to stop circulating and begin restoring.

Clearing Body Clutter: Rituals for Stagnant Energy

Karen Kingston's foundational insight, that clutter in a home is inseparable from clutter in the body and mind that put it there, gives body feng shui its clearing-ritual logic: just as a feng shui clutter-clearing session physically removes stagnant objects from a room to let qi move again, a body-clutter ritual physically removes stagnant tension, stale breath, and unexpressed emotion from the body.

A BODY CLUTTER-CLEARING RITUAL (15 to 20 minutes, done seasonally or whenever a person feels physically 'cluttered' or stuck). Begin by naming, out loud or in writing, three places in the body currently holding old tension (a tight jaw held since a difficult conversation weeks ago; a gripped stomach carried since a stressful season; a locked hip from months of sitting). This naming step mirrors the feng shui practice of consciously acknowledging clutter before removing it, rather than clearing unconsciously. Next, address each named area with movement: shake it out vigorously for thirty seconds (the body-feng-shui equivalent of physically removing an object from a room), then follow immediately with slow, deliberate stretching of the same area for one to two minutes, and finish with three slow breaths directed into that specific area. Close the ritual by changing something physical in the immediate environment, opening a window, changing clothes, tidying the space around you, so the external clearing mirrors and reinforces the internal one.

Some body feng shui writers extend this into a monthly 'closet audit of the body': reviewing which physical habits, postures, and even relationships are being 'worn' out of habit rather than genuine fit, echoing the feng shui wardrobe-clearing principle of removing clothing that no longer represents who a person is now.

Clothing, Color, and the Five Elements

Feng shui's clothing-color guidance is a direct, well-documented extension of the Five Element color associations already used for interiors: Wood is green, Fire is red, Earth is yellow/brown/beige, Metal is white/grey/metallic, and Water is black/navy/deep blue. Consultants in this space commonly advise choosing an outfit's dominant color to either support a depleted personal element or to consciously bring a needed quality into a day, red for visibility and confident self-expression before a presentation (Fire), deep blue or black for calm reserve and rest (Water), green for growth-oriented meetings or creative work (Wood), white or grey for precision and clear boundaries (Metal), and earthy yellow or brown tones for grounding and nourishment during high-stress periods (Earth).

Body feng shui folds this back into the organ-emotion correspondences above, so that a wardrobe choice becomes a small daily Five Element self-treatment: a person noticing Metal-associated grief, tightness in the chest and shallow breath, might deliberately wear white or add a metal accessory, both to support the Lung/Large Intestine organ pair symbolically and to interrupt the mood with a visible, chosen cue, treating dress the way feng shui treats a room's accent color, as a lever on the qi of the space it touches.

This is one of the more explicitly synthetic and least ancient pieces of the system: TCM does not traditionally prescribe clothing color as a treatment, and feng shui's own clothing-color advice is a comparatively recent popular extension of its interior color theory. Readers should hold it as a genuinely modern, low-stakes daily practice rather than a claim of medical or historical authority.

Daily and Seasonal Practices

Feng shui's seasonal framework tracks the Five Elements through the year exactly as TCM does, because both draw on the same Wu Xing seasonal cycle: spring is Wood (growth, new plans, the Liver's domain, a season for gentle, expansive movement and clearing out winter's stagnation); summer is Fire (peak activity, the Heart's domain, a season for social connection and joyful expression, tempered against overheating and agitation); late summer is Earth (harvest and transition, the Spleen/Stomach's domain, a season for nourishing routines and steadying the digestive core); autumn is Metal (letting go, the Lungs' domain, a season for grief work, decluttering, and precise boundary-setting); winter is Water (rest and reserve, the Kidneys' domain, a season for conserving energy, staying warm through the lower back and kidneys, and slow, internal practices).

A body feng shui daily rhythm commonly recommended by practitioners pairs a version of Practice One (the body scan) with the very first minutes of waking, before checking a phone or engaging the day's demands, echoing the feng shui principle that how the front door is greeted in the morning sets the tone for the whole home's qi that day. A midday pause, even ninety seconds of Practice Two's chest-opening movement, is suggested to counter the 'stuffy back hallway' effect of hours spent hunched at a desk. Evenings favor Practice Six's grounding belly-breath, aligned with Water-element wind-down, dimmer light, warmer colors, and less stimulation, mirroring how a well-arranged home is dimmed and quieted at night rather than left as bright and active as midday.

Controversies and Fair Framing

Body feng shui invites two related and fair criticisms, both of which this book takes seriously rather than smoothing over.

The first is the lack-of-ancient-pedigree critique: unlike feng shui itself, which has a genuine multi-thousand-year documented history, or TCM's Five Element and meridian theory, which is likewise ancient and textually attested, 'body feng shui' as a named, systematized practice is a recent (late twentieth to early twenty-first century) Western-wellness-market synthesis, produced mostly by feng shui consultants and wellness authors rather than by any continuous lineage of Chinese medical or geomantic tradition. Presenting it as an unbroken ancient practice in its own right would be inaccurate, and several of its own popularizing authors are explicit that they are building an application, not recovering a lost teaching.

The second is the broader cultural appropriation and commercialization critique leveled at Western feng shui generally: scholars and cultural critics have noted that feng shui's popularization in the West since the 1980s and 1990s often stripped the practice of its cosmological and cultural context, reducing a complex system rooted in Chinese landscape philosophy, ancestor veneration, and dynastic history into decontextualized decorating tips and, in this case, decontextualized self-help. Critics also point to the commercial packaging of feng shui, and by extension body feng shui, into paid consultations, branded object lines, and social-media content that can prioritize marketability over the tradition's depth or the acknowledgment of its Chinese origins.

A fair-minded reader can hold both truths at once: the underlying Five Element and qi-flow cosmology is genuinely ancient, genuinely Chinese, and genuinely shared between feng shui and TCM; the specific act of mapping the bagua onto the human body and treating clothing color as a Five Element self-treatment is a recent, market-shaped synthesis that deserves credit to its real (mostly Chinese-American and Chinese-diaspora, alongside some non-Chinese) popularizers rather than false ancient authority, and deserves to be practiced with acknowledgment of where it came from.

Legacy and Influence in Modern Wellness Culture

Body feng shui's clearest legacy is not as a distinct practice most people name directly, but as an underlying grammar that has quietly shaped mainstream wellness language: 'energy blocks,' 'clearing stagnant energy,' 'grounding,' and 'commanding your space' (extended to commanding your posture or your presence) now circulate widely in yoga studios, corporate wellness programming, and social-media self-help, often without any explicit feng shui or TCM citation, because the vocabulary has been absorbed into general wellness culture.

Within the more specific feng shui-consultant and qigong-teacher communities that do name it directly, body feng shui continues to be actively written about and refined online (blog platforms, newsletters, short-form video), rather than settling into a fixed, closed system, which is itself consistent with its identity as a living, ongoing synthesis rather than a completed ancient tradition.

The Haligricity Lens

Haligricity treats the body as sacred space in its own right, not as a metaphor borrowed from elsewhere but as a first claim: that where a person lives is not only the dwelling they return to but the frame of bone and breath they never leave. Read from that angle, body feng shui's central move, taking a system built for reading and tending an environment and turning it inward on the body, is a small, useful confirmation of something Haligricity already holds: the boundary between 'the space I inhabit' and 'the space I am' is thinner and more permeable than ordinary language admits.

The resonance is structural rather than doctrinal. Body feng shui's bagua-on-the-body mapping shows one culture's tradition discovering, on its own terms and quite recently, that a life-area grid built for rooms can be meaningfully laid over a torso and a spine; Haligricity's synthesis work is interested in exactly this kind of discovery, wherever it surfaces, as evidence that many traditions independently arrive at the intuition that the body is not merely housed by sacred space but is itself continuous with it.

Similarly, the commanding position, supported from behind, open and unbraced in front, offers Haligricity a plain, portable image for what it elsewhere calls presence: not aggression, not collapse, but a stance from which a person can meet what approaches without needing armor. And the Five Element organ-emotion correspondences, genuinely ancient and shared between feng shui and TCM, give Haligricity's broader interest in elemental and correspondence-based theologies one more well-documented data point: that widely separated systems keep independently landing on the idea that emotional life, bodily organ, season, and color are bound together rather than separate.

This section is offered as a synthesis perspective for the general reader, not as a personal application or a claim that Haligricity's own theology of the body derives from feng shui. It is one more thread, honestly labeled as recent where it is recent and ancient where it is ancient, gathered into the wider tapestry Haligricity is weaving.